

William Henry John “Tut” Clowes

Died 1917

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	William Henry John Clowes	CWGC
Date of Birth	c. 1878	
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	4/4/1917 died at home, 36 Eastcote Rd, from the effects of being gas in 1916. This was the home of his older brother James Harrow Cemetery “Recent research has shown that Sergeant William Henry John Clowes is buried here. The Commission is in the process of producing a headstone to mark his grave.”	CWGC, Harrow Observer CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	39	SEE Notes below and link. There is a huge discrepancy between age and what is in the research article linked at the end of this

		document versus the CWGC Age which stated 27. Further research in the John Lyon Archive, when it is available, may clarify his school years and therefore his age.
Marital Status	Single	Roger Slater – link below
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	Plumber	Roger Slater – link below
Parents	William H Clowes and Eliza Clowes	1881 census
Listed Address(s)	At the time of his death he was living at 26 Eastcote Road, Harrow 1881 – Harrow High Street 1891 – ditto 1901 – The Crown & Anchor, High St, Harrow where his father was now the licensed victualler 1911 – boarding at 48 Crown St, Harrow	Obituary (see below) 1881 census 1891 census 1901 census 1911 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Plumber	
Brothers and Sisters	Horatio W Clowes (older), James R Clowes (older), Lillian A Clowes (older)	1881 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary	Two dated 20/4/1917 in Harrow Observer	See below
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	Harrow on the Hill war memorial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11092
	John Lyon School plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340967
	John Lyon School sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	CLOWES W.H.
CWGC Reference	Sergeant William Henry John Clowes War Casualty Details 75470564 CWGC
Age	27
DoD	04-Apr-17
Rank	Sgt
Regiment	Middlesex Regiment, 13th Bn
Location	HARROW CEMETERY - not his actual grave but probably a marker.
Military details	Recent research has shown that Sergeant William Henry John Clowes is buried here. The Commission is in the process of producing a headstone to mark his grave. Sergeant William Henry Clowes (Service Number G/1146) died in April 1917. He served with the Middlesex Regiment (Duke of Cambridge's Own). He died in France on the Western Front. Because his service records were heavily damaged or incomplete, he was originally omitted from official casualty databases. Following rigorous historical adjudication by modern researchers (at Wolverhampton University) looking into pre-war athletic clubs in Harrow and Wealdstone, his case was formally accepted by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission (CWGC) to correct the historic record. Before the war, he was a well-known local sportsman, playing football as a prominent member of Harrow Athletic and the original Wealdstone FC during the mid-1890s alongside his brother, HW Clowes.

Story of Sacrifice

William Henry John “Tut” Clowes (c. 1878 – 1917)

William “Tut” Clowes was a Harrow plumber and local footballer who had previously served in the Middlesex Regiment before being called up as a reservist in September 1914. He served on the Western Front, was severely gassed in France in May 1916, and died at his home in Harrow on 4 April 1917 from the effects of his injuries.

Civilian Life

William Henry John Clowes, known locally as “Tut”, was the son of William and Eliza Clowes. He lived in the Harrow area and worked as a plumber. He was one of three children and had two brothers, Horatio and James, and a sister, Lilian. In the years before the First World War, Clowes was also known as a local footballer, playing as a prominent member of Harrow Athletic and the original Wealdstone FC during the mid-1890s alongside his brother, HW Clowes.

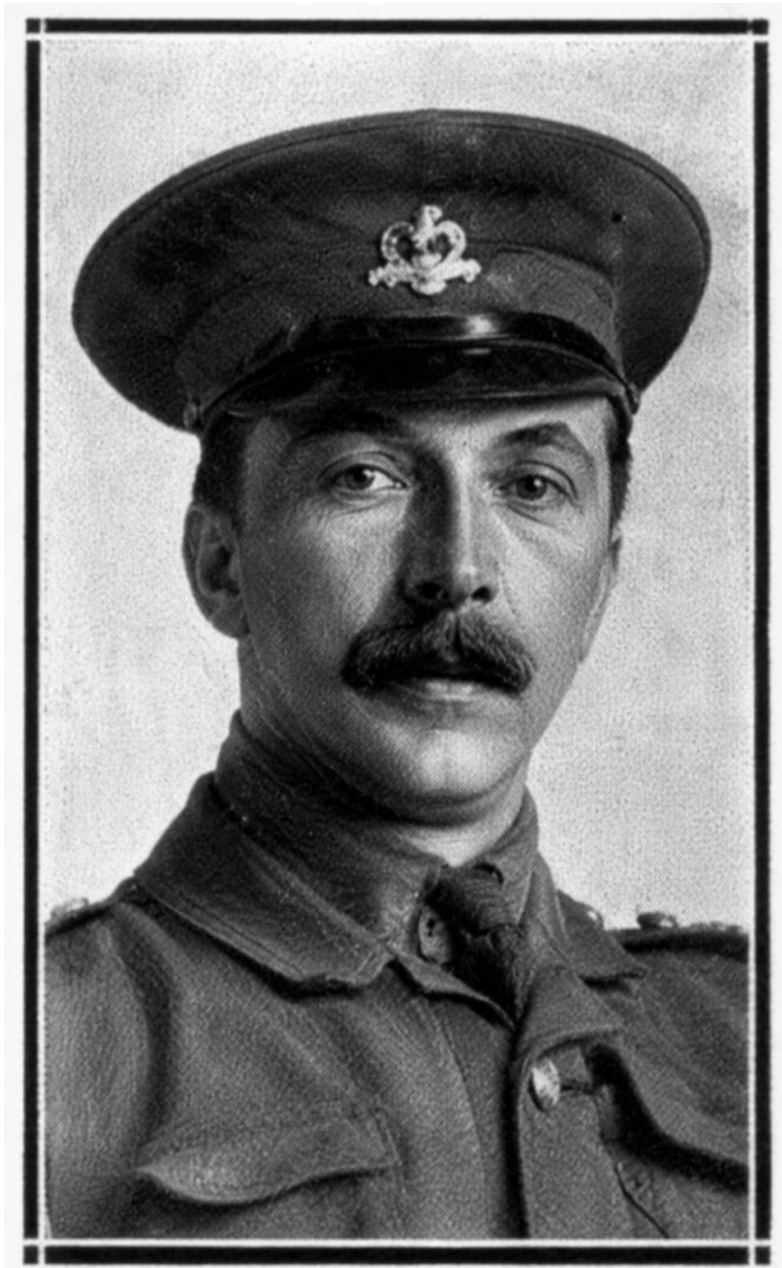
Military Life

Clowes had previously served in the Middlesex Regiment and was in the reserves when war broke out in 1914. He was called up on 3 September 1914 and posted to France in October. He was promoted from acting corporal to corporal and then to sergeant on 11 March 1915. He served on the Western Front, including at the Battle of Loos and during operations in France and Belgium leading up to the Battle of the Somme. On 4 May 1916, Clowes was severely affected by gas while serving in France. He was invalided home in August 1916 and subsequently received treatment at the Great Eastern Hospital in Cambridge, Old Cottage Hospital in Hounslow and Mount Vernon Hospital in Northwood. He was discharged from Mount Vernon after four months, but continued to suffer from the effects of being gassed. He died at 21 Eastcote Road, Harrow, on 4 April 1917.

Footnote

The Commonwealth War Graves Commission (CWGC) record was missing Clowes' details until a University of Wolverhampton researcher, Roger Slater submitted his details for adjudication by CWGC in 2023. Slater had been conducting research into the history of the Harrow and Wealdstone Football Club. Clowes was subsequently recognised by the CWGC, having initially been omitted from official casualty records because his service records were incomplete. A family tomb has been found at St Mary's Harrow on the Hill where his father, grandparents and brother are buried but not William. He was buried with his mother and sister in Pinner Old Cemetery, now Harrow Cemetery, where the CWGC recorded that a headstone was to be provided to mark his grave.

Photos



Clowes Photo AI assuming aged about 36 at time photo was taken



Clowes Photo Original

Notes And Clippings

Harrow Observer, 20/4/1917	
or d r- i- ly g d e le d te y, al er to to 's te at . DIED. SERGT. W. H. CLOWES. Sergt. William Henry John Clowes, late Sergt. Machine Gun Section, 13th Middlesex Regt., died at 21, Eastcote road on April 4th from the effects of being gassed in France, May 4th, 1916. He was well-known in the district where he had many relatives and friends. He joined up in September, 1914, and was in the battles of Loos and various parts of France and Belgium down to the Battle of the Somme from where he was invalided home in August, 1916. He was in the Great Eastern Hospital, Cambridge, for a time ; afterwards he was sent to Old Cottage Hospital, Hounslow, and finally to Mount Vernon, Northwood, where he remained four months, but gradually the gas did its worst and he died at his home greatly respected by all who knew him in his life and who now honour him in death. 1 h t h S il E	DIED. SERGT. W. H. CLOWES. Sergt. William Henry John Clowes, late Sergt. Machine Gun Section, 13th Middlesex Regt., died at 21, Eastcote road on April 4th from the effects of being gassed in France, May 4th, 1916. He was well-known in the district where he had many relatives and friends. He joined up in September, 1914, and was in the battles of Loos and various parts of France and Belgium down to the Battle of the Somme from where he was invalided home in August, 1916. He was in the Great Eastern Hospital, Cambridge, for a time ; afterwards he was sent to Old Cottage Hospital, Hounslow, and finally to Mount Vernon, Northwood, where he remained four months, but gradually the gas did its worst and he died at his home greatly respected by all who knew him in his life and who now honour him in death.

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Note:

<https://www.wlv.ac.uk/research/research-centres/centre-for-historical-research/football-and-war-network/football-and-war-blog/2023/no-stone-untuned/>

He came across William Clowes while researching Wealdstone FC

Info gleaned from above link:

- He mentions a newspaper report from Aug 1916 reporting that William was gassed – I haven't been able to locate
- He says William signed up in 1914 age 36 which would make him c39 when he died and therefore born c1878
- He mentions 2 brothers WH Clowes and HW Clowes associated with the club, originally Harrow Athletic players from the mid-1890s
- William Henry was a player for the merged Harrow Club when the first Wealdstone FC had joined
- William was known as "Tut" Clowes
- One of 3 children of William and Eliza Clowes
- A Harrow Athletic player through the merger with Wealdstone in 1894, still playing at Harrow Athletic in 1900
- Newspaper report of August 1916 said he had been severely gassed on The Somme on the 4 May and was invalided home to recuperate
- Newspaper report (above) about him dying
- Joined up in Sep 1914 aged 36
- He fought in Belgium and France which Roger Slater got from a newspaper dated May 1917
- Rest of his information in newspaper report above
- A family tomb at St Mary's Harrow on the Hill where his father, grandparents and brother are buried but not William
- He was buried with his mother and sister in Pinner Old Cemetery now Harrow Cemetery
- A plumber when war broke out in 1914 he had previously been in the Middlesex Regiment and now was in the reserves. He had joined up around 1904 and served for 3 years
- He was called up at the age of 36yrs 6mos on 3 Sep 1914
- posted to France in October 1914. He was made up to Acting Corporal three weeks later and full Corporal in January 1915, before once again being promoted to Sergeant on 11th March 1915. Serving along the Western Front he was gassed and eventually discharged unfit for further service on 30th August 1916
- As mentioned in the newspaper cutting, he spent time in a number of hospitals, eventually being discharged from Mount Vernon Hospital in Northwood a matter of days before his eventual death, unmarried and without children, at 21 Eastcote Road, the home of his older brother James Keeling Cowes [sic?] and his wife, Agnes.
- Other siblings: Horatio (d1948); sister Lilian Alice Clowes, bn1873 but died 1897